

Lesson 14 — Recovery and Resilience



What helps people recover and what protective factors matter?

 In this activity, you will identify and explain protective factors that support recovery and resilience after substance use.

Understanding the recovery process

Recovery from substance use is a journey that involves physical, mental, and social changes. It is not just about stopping a harmful behavior, but about building a healthier and more sustainable lifestyle. By understanding the factors that help people recover, we can better support ourselves and others in building resilience.

Term	Definition and context
Resilience	Resilience is the ability to adapt well in the face of adversity, trauma, or significant sources of stress.
Protective Factors	A protective factor is a condition or attribute that increases an individual's ability to avoid risks and recover from challenges.
Recovery	Recovery is the process of improving one's health and wellness while living a self-directed life.

Read the recovery guide

Read the following passage carefully. As you read, ask yourself: What specific elements contribute most to a person's ability to bounce back from difficult situations?

Recovery is a complex process that relies on more than just willpower. It requires a support system and the development of healthy coping mechanisms. Resilience is built when an individual identifies their personal strengths and learns to navigate challenges effectively.

Protective factors are the tools that guard against future harm. These include strong family relationships, engagement in school or hobbies, and having supportive peers who encourage healthy choices. When a person feels connected to their community, their ability to remain resilient increases significantly.

Effective recovery often involves setting small, achievable goals. These goals help rebuild confidence and provide a sense of purpose. Additionally, developing problem-solving skills allows individuals to handle stress without turning back to substance use. Resilience is not a fixed trait; it is a skill that can be strengthened over time.

Building your connections

Connect the ideas from the text to your own understanding of health by completing the table below.

Key Concept	Your Understanding	Why is this important?
Protective Factors	Factors that reduce risk and support health.	They act as a buffer against life's challenges.
Resilience	Write your answer here	Write your answer here
Support Systems		
Goal Setting		
+ Add a row or column as needed		

Try it out

Use what you learned to solve the problems below.

Scenario Question	Response
How could a supportive friend act as a protective factor for someone in recovery?	Write your answer here
Why might setting small goals be more effective than setting one giant goal?	
Identify one activity you do that acts as a protective factor for your own mental health.	



Show what you learned

Create a digital visual to share your understanding of recovery and resilience with others. Use Magic Media or Elements to help visualise or record your idea.

- Choose a creative format such as a digital poster or an infographic.
- Identify at least three major protective factors from the lesson.
- Explain how these factors support resilience in a few short sentences.
- Arrange your visuals and text to make your key points easy to read.

[Double click to design here]



Reflect on your learning

Reflect on the work you have completed so far regarding recovery and the factors that influence resilience.

Explain the difference between a risk factor and a protective factor using an example from your own life or the lesson.

[Write your answer here.]

What is one thing you learned today that changed how you view recovery?

How will you use the concept of resilience if you face a difficult challenge in the future?